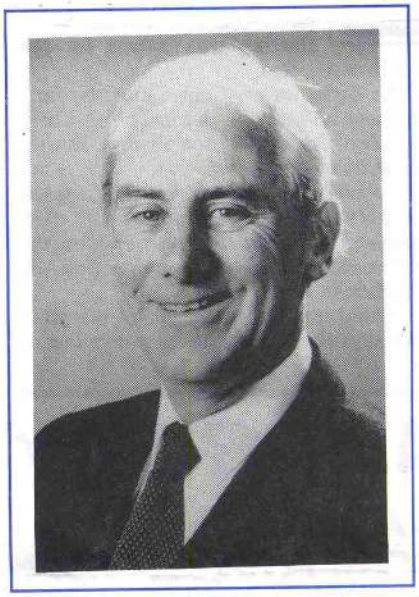
Thamesmead Times

ELECTION SPECIAL

APRIL 1993

"IT'S IN YOUR INTEREST TO VOTE" — Chairman



● Sir James Mellon

ELECTIONS have been called this month in three of Thamesmead Town's constituencies for Directors' seats on the Board. Every year one third of the Elected Directors stand for re-election.

Polling Day is Saturday, April 24 but only two of the three seats will be contested because there was only one candidate in Area 7, Lesnes. Pat Daniels has been re-elected unopposed for that area.

Voters were given the chance to question candidates for the other two constituencies (Broadwaters and Manorway) at public meetings on 31 March, 1993. I attended both those meetings and the turnout was, quite frankly, disappointing although the inclement weather might have been a factor.

Ballot papers will have been delivered to everyone entitled to vote by April 10.

The people elected will be Directors of a Company and are there to ensure that we develop the town and community as a whole. Being a Director of Thamesmead Town is a responsible position. It is vital for the well being of the community that we have people of the highest calibre. Devoted, not only, to the interests of people in their area but to the community as a whole. I urge each and every resident of Thamesmead who is entitled to exercise their vote. It is in everyone's interest that they should vote and that the Directors are elected to do the job with the support of the electorate in their constituencies.

JAMES MELLON
Chairman

USE YOUR OPPORTUNITY TO ELECT YOUR BOARD MEMBER

ELECTIONS have been called this month in three of Thamesmead Town's constituencies for Directors' seats on the Board.

However, April 24 will be a polling day in just two of the three Areas concerned because only one candidate came forward in Lesnes, Area 7.

Therefore the sitting Director for Lesnes, Pat Daniels, is elected unopposed.

In Broadwaters, Area 1, sitting Director Ray Hutchins is being challenged by Craig White.

In Manorway, Area 4, there's another two horse race between the sitting Director, Vijay Vithani, and Gerry Bright.

Town's democratic structure

NINE elected Directors representing the nine areas of Thamesmead serve on the Town's Board.

The remaining three seats on the Board are taken up by the Chairman, Chief Executive and Director of Finance, all of whom are appointed by the elected Directors.

To qualify for candidature, prospective Directors must live in the Area they hope to represent. Directors serve for three years before having to stand for re-election. Elections are held in rotation in three of the areas every year.

The idea of the phased elections is to allow for gradual change rather than a potential mass exodus of Board members which could result in a loss of policy continuity.

To vote in these elections, you must live in the Areas concerned and be 18 years old by April 24, 1993. Ballot papers will be delivered to your homes.

Thamesmead Town is a private company, not a local authority like the councils. It receives no subsidies from central or local government, and must balance its books like any other company.

But as a company, Thamesmead Town is unique in the way that it is controlled by the community through its elected Directors.

HOW TO VOTE

For Broadwaters residents

(Area 1)

Polling will be at Heronsgate Primary School Goosander Way, Thamesmead West on Saturday April 24 between 10 a.m. and 4 p.m.

For Manorway residents

(Area 4)

Polling will be at Bishop John Robinson Primary School Hoveton Road, Thamesmead North on Saturday April 24 between 10 a.m. and 4 p.m.

You can vote by post using the pre-paid envelope provided with your ballot paper. Postal votes should be posted no later than **Wednesday April 21** to make sure they are with the Returning Officer in time.

BATTLE FOR BROADWATERS

RAY TO FIGHT FOR "FORGOTTEN AREA"



THE existing Director for Broadwaters, Ray Hutchins, is standing again for what he calls "our often forgotten area of the Town".

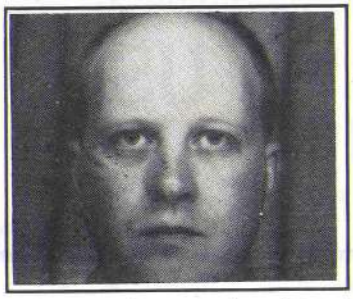
He says he has improved community links over the past 11 years since he first moved to Thamesmead West and has built up a good relationship with officers of both Thamesmead Town and Greenwich Council as well as other authorities and agencies.

Ray believes this relationship has helped him get things done when it comes to the problems and living and social conditions of Broadwaters.

He points out that he has taken up hundreds of problems on behalf of his constituents and claims that what Broadwaters needs to improve its environment is more security projects.

Ray wants to speed up the decision-making process at Thamesmead Town in order to increase efficiency and cut costs. He says the next three years will be vital for the development of Broadwaters and he will press hard for a Post Office, the completion of Gallions Park, a community centre and a custom-built health centre.

CRAIG PLEDGES FRESH APPROACH



BROADWATERS challenger Craig White has lived in the Area for five years with his wife and two young children and is promising a fresh approach if he is victorious.

His slogan is "community focused, politically independent", which he says means exactly what it says . . . no party politics, just issues reflecting what's best for the residents and community of Broadwaters.

He says the facilities of the Broadwaters Centre must be fully utilised so that the Area can have a "heart" — a focal point where residents can meet, discuss local issues and socialise. A livelier community life is one of his primary objectives.

As a parent, he's calling for a zebra crossing at the school, a speed limit, warning signs and possibly a traffic calming system.

Craig expresses disappointment at the litter and mess spoiling the environment and says he will launch a clean-up campaign, possibly using volunteers, to restore pride in the Area.

If elected, he promises to hold regular meetings and maintain dialogue with residents. He says that true representation means consultation.

TWO HORSE RACE IN MANORWAY

GERRY WANTS BETTER VALUE FOR MONEY



Challenger Gerry Bright says that having lived in Thamesmead since 1968, when the population was less than 100, his experience of the Town's life are wide and varied.

He wants better value for money from the Company for all residents and is promising to press for improved facilities and leisure opportunities for everyone, especially the young.

Positive action must be taken to stop damage, vandalism and unruly behaviour, he says.

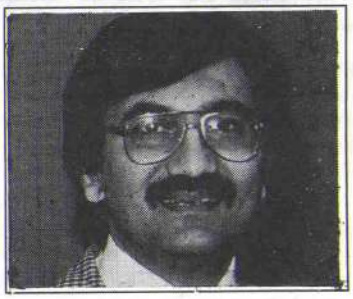
A founder member of Thamesmead Community Association and its Chairman for a long period, Gerry was until last year involved with Thamesmead Town FC. He spent more than 20 years with the Club and was its manager for many years.

He works with local schools and One O'Clock Clubs, both as a fund raiser and "Father Christmas". He was employed by Thamesmead Town from the GLC days and was responsible for emergency services until retirement last year.

Gerry is still Secretary of the Trade Union in the Company, but will resign from that post if elected.

He says many areas in Thamesmead have higher priority than Manorway and believes all Areas should be equal. The high percentage of elderly people in Manorway need safe and peaceful surroundings, and he pledges to fight for a better environment for both the OAPs and all other residents.

VIJAY CALLING FOR EXPANSION AND JOBS



SITTING Director Vijay Vithani, also well known for his dentistry practice in Thamesmead Town Centre, is eager to see an expanding community and more jobs.

Having moved to Thamesmead with his wife in 1988, he served for two-and-a-half years on the Thamesmead Advisory Forum before successfully seeking election to the Board.

His work included the victorious fight against proposed Boundary Commission changes, new housing planned for site 3P (off Crossway) and the selection of the new Thamesmead Town Chairman. Vijay says his efforts have borne fruit in the form of new public open spaces, better cleaning standards and improvements in the Town's financial viability.

He's committed to the Company's Equal Opportunities policies. A family man with two young daughters, he wants the best for the Town's residents and children and is keen to continue his involvement in the community.

For the future, Vijay is an enthusiastic supporter of plans for an expanded Town Centre. He wants to see more housing development, in partnership with outside agencies, and the creation of jobs for local people.

He pledges that, if elected, he will help the people of Manorway, whether they are homeowners or tenants, on personal problems, cleaning, road adoptions, public spaces and education.

ELECTED UNOPPOSED



PAT DANIELS, the only declared candidate in Lesnes (Area 7) is elected unopposed. Victorious in a 1989 by-election, this will be Pat's second full three-year term of office.

In her election address this month, she promised to keep up the pressure against graffiti and for improved standards of cleanliness. She said rent and service charge money should be spent, as far as possible, on improving the quality of life in Thamesmead

She called for clear and fair policies on lettings and other housing matters and said the Town must continue to develop with the aim of building a complete community with affordable homes for rent and sale.